

OpenClaw Switching Models

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1. Course Content

This course systematically introduces OpenClaw's model selection working mechanism and three ways to switch models.

2. Temporarily Switching the Session Model

2.1 Open a TUI Session

- Enter in the terminal

```
openclaw tui
```

2.2 Use `/model` to Switch the Session Model

Command	Description
<code>/model</code>	View the list of available models and select a model to switch to

- Enter `/model` in the session input box; for example, here we switch to `bailian/qwen3.5-plus`. Use the up/down arrow keys on the keyboard to select the model, then press Enter

3. Switching the Default Model

3.1 Switch via CLI

The simplest way is to directly set the default model with a CLI command:

- Here, switching to the `bailian/qwen3.6-plus` model is used as an example

```
openclaw models set bailian/qwen3.6-plus
```

```
Updated ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Default model: bailian/qwen3.6-plus
jatsen@vabhoom:~$
```

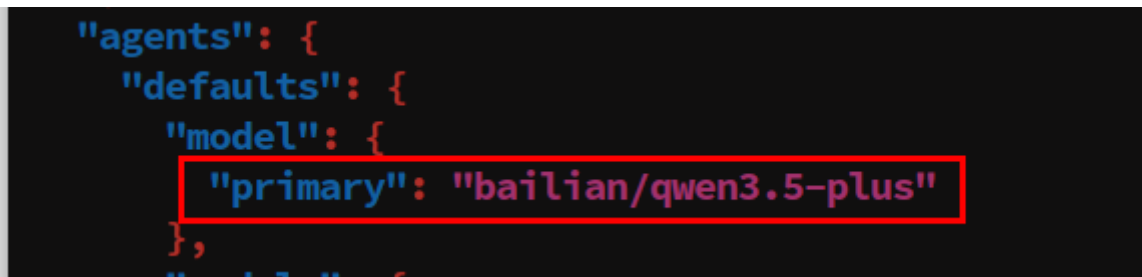
3.2 Switch via the Configuration File

- Edit the `openclaw.json` configuration file to modify the Agent's default model

```
nano $HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json
# Or use your preferred editor, such as vim, code, etc. It is recommended to
edit with an IDE like VS Code for more convenience
```

In `openclaw.json`, specify the primary model to use by default through the `agents.defaults.model.primary` configuration item:

```
{
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

A terminal screenshot showing the configuration file `openclaw.json` being edited. The JSON structure is displayed with syntax highlighting. The line `"primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"` is highlighted with a red rectangular box.

- Verify whether the configuration takes effect:

```
openclaw models status
```

```
Before runtime loads
Config       : ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Agent dir    : ~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent
Default      : bailian/qwen3.5-plus
Fallbacks (0) : -
Image model   : -
Image fallbacks (0): -
Aliases (0)  : -
Configured models (9): bailian/qwen3.5-plus, bailian/qwen3.6-plus, bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23, bailian/qwen3-coder-next, bailian/qwen3-coder-plus, bailian/MiniMax-M2.5, bailian/glm-5, bailian/glm-4.7, bailian/kimi-k2.5
```

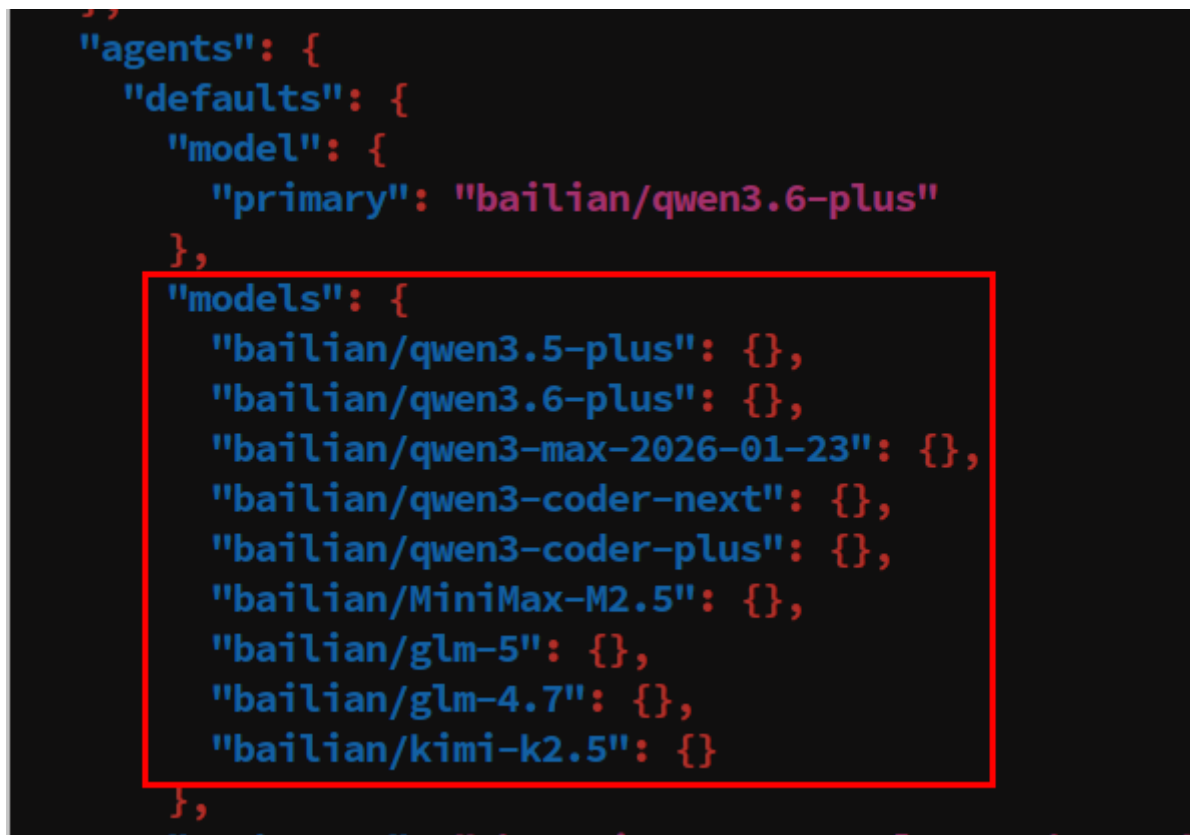
4. Adding to the Model Options List

- `agents.defaults.models` is the **allowlist/catalog** in OpenClaw that controls the range of models that can be used. Once this configuration item is set, users can only use the models contained in the list. This list also serves as the scope control basis for the `/model` command and session overrides.

4.1 Add Models via the Configuration File

Configure `agents.defaults.models` in `openc1aw.json` to add the models you need to use to the allowlist:

```
{
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      },
      "models": {
        "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
        "bailian/qwen3.6-plus": {},
        "bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23": {},
        "bailian/qwen3-coder-next": {},
        "bailian/qwen3-coder-plus": {},
        "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
        "bailian/glm-5": {},
        "bailian/glm-4.7": {},
        "bailian/kimi-k2.5": {}
      }
    }
  }
}
```



```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.6-plus"
    },
    "models": {
      "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen3.6-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-coder-next": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-coder-plus": {},
      "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
      "bailian/glm-5": {},
      "bailian/glm-4.7": {},
      "bailian/kimi-k2.5": {}
    }
  }
}
```

4.2 Add to the Agent Model List via CLI Commands

Use the `openc1aw config set` command to safely edit the allowlist without manually modifying the JSON file:

```
openc1aw config set agents.defaults.models.bailian/qwen3-plus '{}'
```

```

"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.6-plus"
    },
    "models": {
      "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen3.6-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-coder-next": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-coder-plus": {},
      "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
      "bailian/glm-5": {},
      "bailian/glm-4.7": {},
      "bailian/kimi-k2.5": {},
      "openai/gpt-5.4": {}
    }
  }
},

```

4.3 Model Reference Format Specification

In OpenClaw, all model references use a unified format:

```
provider/model-ID
```

Examples:

Model Reference	Description
anthropic/claude-opus-4-6	Anthropic's Claude Opus model
anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6	Anthropic's Claude Sonnet model
openai/gpt-5.4	OpenAI's GPT-5.4 model
openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2	The case where the model ID itself contains a slash

Note: If the model ID itself contains `/` (such as `moonshotai/kimi-k2`), you must provide the full reference in the `openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2` format.